Duke University - Course Evaluations
Graduate Course Evaluations - Spring 2025

Course: ENVIRON-558L-001: REMOTE SENSING FOR ENVI ANALY.ENVIRON-558L-001.
Instructor: Tong Qiu
TA: Yu Wei *
Response Rate: 17/20 (85.00 %)

1 - Your personal level of engagement with the course was:

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent
Very low	(1)	0	0.00%
Low	(2)	0	0.00%
Medium	(3)	6	35.29%
High	(4)	5	29.41%
Very high	(5)	6	35.29%

Percent Responses: 0 25 50 100

Means: 4.00 (Question), 4.16 (Dept/Program (GRAD)), 4.11 (GRAD Overall)

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Dept/Program (GRAD)	Mean	STD	Median	GRAD Overall	Mean	STD	Median
17/20 (85.00%)	4.00	0.87	4.00	696	4.16	0.85	4.00	4692	4.11	0.87	4.00

2 - What knowledge, methods, skills, insights, or ways of thinking did you develop in this course? Please describe three specific things you learned.

Response Rate	13/20 (65%)

- Remote sensing
- ENVI Google Earth Engine Knowledge of various satellite technology
- Using ENVI and GEE.
- This was my first ever geospatial/remote sensing class and thought it was a great introduction to the field
- I learned how to apply NDVI and EVI to potential future project.
- Uses of bands for remote sensing, techniques for analysis, platforms of analysis
- 1. Underlying principles/logistics of remote sensing methods 2. ENVI (to some extent)
- How to process remotely sensed data, the different kinds of remote sensing data, how to classify land cover types from remote sensing data
- I learned what is possible and where emerging science and technology is in the field. I learned how to use ENVI. i know the general processes involved in remote sensing.
- Full in depth understanding of remote sensing and the tools behind it. As well as future improvements that are happening.
- Everything about remote sensing--different types of sensors and satellites, land cover classification, accuracy assessment, google earth engine, LIDAR analysis, hyperspectral remote sensing, and maybe most importantly feeling confident and adept at using ENVI software.
- I learned how to use both ENVI and Google Earth Engine, and I also have an understanding of the fundamentals of remote sensing, its capabilities and the potential issues that are often encountered.
- So many things: steps for cleaning RS data, data acquisition, satellite system operations, how to combine different bands for targeted analysis

3 - Reflecting on the overall learning environment of this class, in what ways did the instructor(s) and the structure or components of the course facilitate your learning? Are there specific course components or methods of instruction you'd keep for future years?

Response Rate	12/20 (60%)

- The lab component is useful but I want to learn more not just copy and paste. Or click and click. But more to understand the principle and rationale of doing things
- Well done!
- The lab documents were a really great portion of the class.
- The labs were very meaningful and thorough!
- Tong's charisma and positive attitude aided in my learning. I would keep the lectures as I learned so much from them.
- Good attitude. Good lecturer. Funny sense of humor.
- I enjoyed the google earth engine components. Could be cool to do more with that!
- I like that there were lots of labs that were easy to complete to help us practice remote sensing and that there was an in person midterm of appropriate difficulty to help us memorize some basics.
- The labs and lectures were very put together. We were able to get a lot of help when needed and explanations were great.
- Tong was a great lecturer and I thought the lectures were good at providing an overview of different tools for us to then dive into in the lab. I thought the labs were all really fun and helpful without being too much work, which was a nice balance.
- I felt that the labs were really helpful in applying and learning the material. I also thought that the lectures were well organized.
- Great lectures, great labs and overall great course

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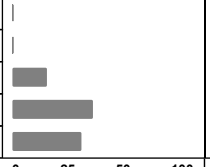
4 - What might improve the course? Are there specific course components or methods of instruction you'd change for future years? Did anything in particular impede a positive learning environment?

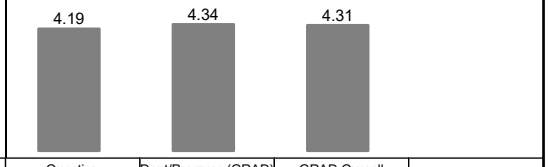
Response Rate	12/20 (60%)

- The lectures are way to easy I think. Tong has a very high tendency to jumping between the topics but the lecture contents should be more organized
- More structure around the final project - make it a semester long ordeal
- I preferred when Tong lectured rather than student presentations.
- I think understanding more about the coding in google earth engine would be very useful, since it is still open source and useable in more contexts
- I would suggest more lenient due dates for the labs as some are much harder/time intensive than others.
- More google earth engine.
- I think some of the modules were quite similar to topics we learned related to remote sensing in our introduction to GIS course. So maybe having more consideration for topics students would have already covered could be good.
- I'd have the lab structure a little more laxed. I don't think there is ever reason to write a full lab report. I would've also learned a little more if there was a small portion of instruction at the begining of lab.
- If we started the course project earlier it might be better.
- I did feel like the first half of the course was fairly surface level and a lot of things that we had learned already in Fundmentals of GIS--we went into them in more depth in this course obviously, but the remote sensing unit in Fundamentals was pretty good. If you made Fundemantals a prerequisite for this course, then you could be certain that students have already been exposed to some of what we did in the beginning of the class, and would be able to get more complex earlier on.
- Sometimes the material was too dense. It would have been helpful to use more visual examples or work through labs a little bit more to help us understand exactly what we were doing (or the code we were using). The only issue I had was with he way that attendance was taken "randomly" for it to be truly random the dates would need to be preselected by a random generator before the class began or taken every week to be acurrate. The statistical difference between the grade I received in attendance versus my actual attendance rate is significant.
- Nothing- everything was great!!!

5 - The course was intellectually stimulating. It made me think in new ways, encouraged me to adopt different points of view, or challenged me to develop new skills.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%
Marginal	(2)	0	0.00%
Average	(3)	3	18.75%
Very Good	(4)	7	43.75%
Excellent	(5)	6	37.50%





Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Dept/Program (GRAD)	Mean	STD	Median	GRAD Overall	Mean	STD	Median
16/20 (80.00%)	4.19	0.75	4.00	695	4.34	0.86	5.00	4646	4.31	0.86	5.00

6 - What made this class stimulating or how could it be more intellectually stimulating if it wasn't?

Response Rate	11/20 (55%)

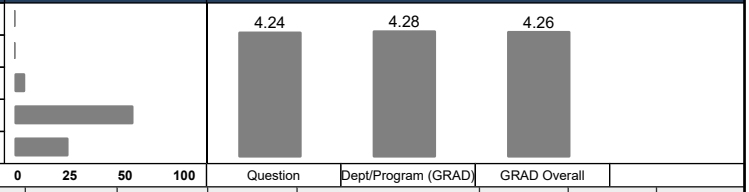
- The lecture can be better. I always left with the class with a feeling of didn't learn much
- Less student presentations.
- More in depth discussion around labs, and connecting them with the presentations we were doing. Making the presentations interactive in a way
- This class was stimulating in which it was a topic that I had little knowledge in but was thirsty to learn.
- It was great. Would love to hear how Tong uses these tools in his research.
- Very engaging lectures!
- Tong made it interesting. But exploring more applied uses of remote sensing would have helped.
- The labs were very cool and interesting and took the appropriate amount of time.
- It was very stimulating and a great way to learn a new skill. In terms of improvement, mostly what I said above about fewer things that were review.
- All of the subject matter was new to me, so it was very interesting.
- A lot of the course felt like a review of the few lectures we had on remote sensing in 559 (the fundamentals of GIS coarse). For some of the topics we definitely dug deeper, but I would have loved for the class to be more theory heavy.

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7 - Considering all components of the course (lectures, discussions, sections/labs, assessments, projects, course environment, etc), overall the course was

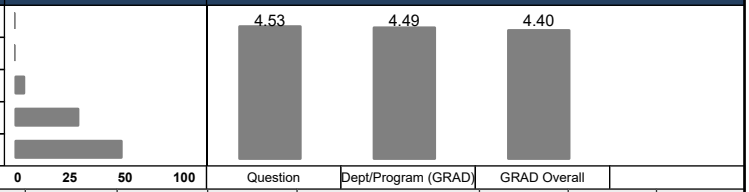
Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%
Marginal	(2)	0	0.00%
Average	(3)	1	5.88%
Very Good	(4)	11	64.71%
Excellent	(5)	5	29.41%



Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Dept/Program (GRAD)	Mean	STD	Median	GRAD Overall	Mean	STD	Median
17/20 (85.00%)	4.24	0.56	4.00	693	4.28	0.88	4.00	4666	4.26	0.88	4.00

8 - Based on the effectiveness of instruction (clarity, expertise, enthusiasm, rigor, support, inspiration, etc), overall the instructor, Tong Qiu, was -

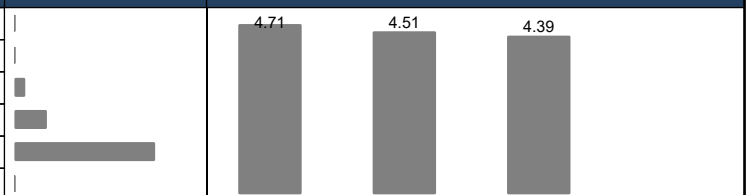
Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%
Marginal	(2)	0	0.00%
Average	(3)	1	5.88%
Very Good	(4)	6	35.29%
Excellent	(5)	10	58.82%



Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Dept/Program (GRAD)	Mean	STD	Median	GRAD Overall	Mean	STD	Median
17/20 (85.00%)	4.53	0.62	5.00	790	4.49	0.81	5.00	5252	4.40	0.86	5.00

9 - Based on the effectiveness of instruction (clarity, expertise, enthusiasm, rigor, support, inspiration, etc), overall the teaching assistant, Yu Wei, was

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%
Marginal	(2)	0	0.00%
Average	(3)	1	5.88%
Very good	(4)	3	17.65%
Excellent	(5)	13	76.47%
N/A	(0)	0	0.00%



Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Dept/Program (GRAD)	Mean	STD	Median	GRAD Overall	Mean	STD	Median
17/20 (85.00%)	4.71	0.59	5.00	266	4.51	0.76	5.00	1362	4.39	0.88	5.00

10 - In what ways did the teaching assistant(s) facilitate your learning and what might have helped even more? Include any constructive comments you'd like to share with Yu Wei here.

Response Rate	10/20 (50%)

- Always available for questions and clarification. Yu was great!!
- They did an incredible job with answering emails and helping with components of the labs!
- She was always available to answer questions that I had on labs.
- Very knowledgeable. Could always answer questions.
- Helped me clarify & troubleshoot some of the challenges I've encountered in class
- Yu was really great!
- Yu is an amazing TA always very helpful and responsive. Nicholas school is lucky to have her.
- Yu was extremely flexible and helpful for the labs!
- Yu was an excellent TA, answered questions helpfully and was always quick to respond.
- Great communication and timeliness- no improvements

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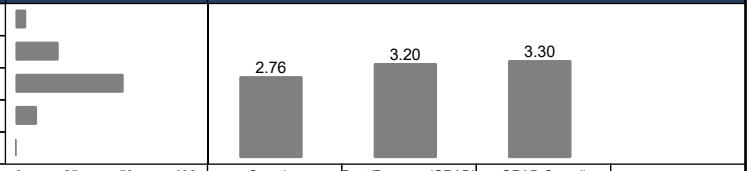
11 - What would you like to say about this course to a student who is considering taking it in the future?

Response Rate	8/20 (40%)

- Highly reccomend! Definitely had an improved experience since I already took GIS
- If you are interested in global/long range data collection it is such a great start.
- Take it.
- Go for it.
- This should be required for all foresters.
- Definitely take it if you are interested in remote sensing in any way!
- The course is quite a bit manageable. The skills learned in the lab are very transferrable and worth learning.
- TAKE IT!! You will learn so much and have a great clsss with Professor Qiu

12 - The course was difficult.

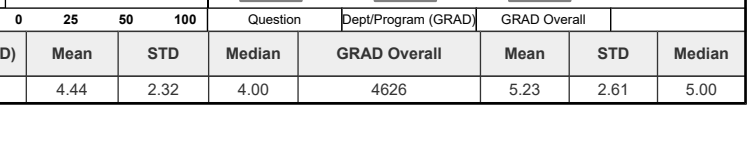
Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses
Strongly disagree	(1)	1	5.88%	
Disagree	(2)	4	23.53%	
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	10	58.82%	
Agree	(4)	2	11.76%	
Strongly agree	(5)	0	0.00%	



Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Dept/Program (GRAD)	Mean	STD	Median	GRAD Overall	Mean	STD	Median
17/20 (85.00%)	2.76	0.75	3.00	688	3.20	0.97	3.00	4655	3.30	1.02	3.00

13 - How many hours in a typical week did you spend on this course (outside of class meetings)?

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses
1	(1)	0	0.00%	
2	(2)	3	18.75%	
3	(3)	6	37.50%	
4	(4)	4	25.00%	
5	(5)	3	18.75%	
6	(6)	0	0.00%	
7	(7)	0	0.00%	
8	(8)	0	0.00%	
9	(9)	0	0.00%	
10+	(10)	0	0.00%	



Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Dept/Program (GRAD)	Mean	STD	Median	GRAD Overall	Mean	STD	Median
16/20 (80.00%)	3.44	1.03	3.00	680	4.44	2.32	4.00	4626	5.23	2.61	5.00